CORE FALSE BELIEF #1 · MY WORTH

“Something is wrong with me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief often starts early. A child who is criticized, compared, ignored, teased, or treated as a problem can conclude, “The trouble must be me.” Painful experiences such as abuse, rejection, divorce, or a parent’s anger can leave the same message, because children tend to blame themselves for what adults do. Later, every mistake, struggle, or difference seems to confirm it. Over time the feeling of being “broken” or “not like other people” can settle in so deeply that it feels like a fact rather than a belief.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that every person is affected by sin and lives in a broken world. But the Bible never says that you are uniquely defective or that you are the one thing God got wrong. You were made in God’s image. The psalmist praised God because he was fearfully and wonderfully made. In Christ, there is now no condemnation, and anyone in Him is a new creation. Struggles, weaknesses, and scars are real, and some deserve care and help, but they are things you have, not the whole of who you are. God knows you completely and still calls you His workmanship.

> *“For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well”* (Psalm 139:13–14).

Also see

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life” (Ephesians 2:10).

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” (Romans 8:1).

> “Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!” (2 Corinthians 5:17).

Common self-statements

- Other people seem normal; I am not.
- If people really knew me, they would see what is wrong with me.
- I always mess things up because I am broken.
- Everyone else got something I was born without.
- When things go wrong, it must be my fault.
- I have to hide the real me.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Calling my whole self “wrong” because of a struggle, a mistake, or a painful feeling.
- Overgeneralization: Treating a few hard moments as proof that I am defective in every way.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing that because I feel broken, I must be broken.

- Personalization: Assuming that other people's anger, rejection, or problems were caused by something wrong in me.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I mean by "something is wrong with me"? Can I name it?
- When did I first start believing this, and who taught it to me?
- Is this a struggle I have, or is it the whole of who I am?
- Would I say this about a friend who had the same struggles I have?
- What evidence do I have that I am loved, valued, or capable?
- How does God describe the people He has made and redeemed?

Truth summary

> I have struggles, weaknesses, and wounds, like every person. But I am not a mistake. God made me in His image, knows me completely, and calls me His workmanship. My struggles are something I can work on and bring to Him; they are not the final word about who I am.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Something is wrong with me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something is wrong with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I mean when I say something is wrong with me?
- ☐ Where did I first learn this belief?
- ☐ Is this something I have, or who I am?
- ☐ What would I say to a friend with the same struggle?
- ☐ What evidence says I am valued and capable?
- ☐ What does God say about the people He has made?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Having a struggle does not make me defective.
- ☐ What was done to me does not define me.
- ☐ God knows me fully and still loves me.
- ☐ I can grow without first proving I am worth it.
- ☐ In Christ, there is no condemnation for me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 139:13–14**
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ **Ephesians 2:10**
  "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."
- ☐ **Romans 8:1**
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the "something is wrong with me" feeling came: Each day, write down one moment when you felt broken or different. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:13–14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God knit me together. I have struggles, but I am not a mistake; I am wonderfully made.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Separate the struggle from the self. Write the belief as "I am...". Then rewrite it as "I have..." or "I struggle with...". Notice how the second version feels.
- [ ] Collect the other side of the evidence. Ask one trusted person to tell you two good things they see in you. Write them down and read them, even if you do not believe them yet.
- [ ] Let one safe person see a little more of you. Share one small, honest thing about yourself with a trusted friend, family member, or church member. Notice whether they turn away or stay.
- [ ] Get help for what is real. If something truly needs attention, such as a health concern, a habit, or a painful memory, take one step toward help this week: a doctor, pastor, or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something is wrong with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I did not feel broken
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something is wrong with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You formed me and You know me completely. When I feel broken or different, remind me that I am Your workmanship and not a mistake. Help me separate my struggles from who I am, bring my wounds to You for healing, and receive the love You have already given me in Christ. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #2 · MY WORTH

“I am worthless.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many people learn this belief from the way they were treated: being called names, put down, ignored, used, or compared unfavorably with others. When love depended on grades, looks, money, or behavior, a child can conclude that a person is only worth what he or she produces. Losses such as a divorce, a job loss, a disability, or growing older can reawaken it later. Our culture adds to it by measuring people by success, popularity, and appearance.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture places a person’s worth in God, not in performance. Jesus said that not one sparrow falls apart from the Father, and that you are worth more than many sparrows. God calls His people precious and honored in His sight. The clearest measure of your worth is the price that was paid for you: not silver or gold, but the precious blood of Christ. Your worth was settled by God before you did anything right or wrong, and nothing you do can add to or subtract from His love.

> *“Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground apart from the will of your Father. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows”* (Matthew 10:29–31).

Also see

> “For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life you inherited from your forefathers, but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or spot” (1 Peter 1:18–19).

> “Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life” (Isaiah 43:4).

> “What is man that You are mindful of him, or the son of man that You care for him? You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor” (Psalm 8:4–5).

> “But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8).

Common self-statements

- I am not worth anything.
- Other people matter; I don’t.
- If I disappeared, no one would notice.
- I have nothing to offer.
- I only matter when I am useful.
- I don’t deserve good things.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Giving myself a single word, “worthless,” that ignores everything else that is true about me.
- Mental filter: Remembering every failure or rejection and overlooking the times I helped, loved, or was valued.
- Emotional reasoning: Concluding I have no worth because I feel worthless.
- Comparison: Measuring my value against other people’s gifts, looks, or success.

Challenging questions

- Who decides what a person is worth: other people, my feelings, or God?
- Where did I first learn that I was worthless?
- Would I call a friend worthless for the same reasons I call myself worthless?
- What price did God pay for me, and what does that say about my value?
- Is my worth something I earn, or something I was given?
- What would change in my day if I believed I was precious to God?

Truth summary

> My worth does not come from what I do, how I look, or what others say. God made me, values me, and paid the highest price for me in Christ. I may feel worthless at times, but feelings are not the final word. I am precious and honored in His sight.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God
- Christ, Sacrifice of
- God, All Loving
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

Dear Younger Me — MercyMe
Past wounds and choices do not have to become a person's permanent identity.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am worthless"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am worthless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who decides what I am worth?
- ☐ Where did I learn that I was worthless?
- ☐ Would I say this about a friend?
- ☐ What price did God pay for me?
- ☐ Is my worth earned or given?
- ☐ What would change if I believed I was precious?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am worth more than many sparrows.
- ☐ I was bought with the precious blood of Christ.
- ☐ My worth was given, not earned.
- ☐ Feeling worthless is not the same as being worthless.
- ☐ I am precious and honored in God's sight.
- ☐ I can treat myself as someone God values.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 10:29–31**
  "Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground apart from the will of your Father. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- ☐ **1 Peter 1:18–19**
  "For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life you inherited from your forefathers, but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or spot."
- ☐ **Isaiah 43:4**
  "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When I felt worthless: Each day, write one moment when you felt worthless. Note what triggered it and write one truth from this card that answers it.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 10:29–31 becomes: "David can write: "God sees every sparrow, and I am worth more than many sparrows. My worth is settled by Him.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Write your "worth" list. List five things God says about you from the verses on this card. Read the list each morning for one week.
- [ ] Treat yourself as valuable for one day. Do one ordinary act of care for yourself, such as a good meal, rest, or a walk, as if you were caring for someone God loves.
- [ ] Notice the put-downs. Each time you call yourself worthless or stupid, stop and replace it with a sentence you would say to a friend.
- [ ] Let someone see your value. Accept one compliment this week without arguing. Simply say, "Thank you."

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I am worthless": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I treated myself as valuable
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am worthless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have measured my worth by what others said and by what I could do. Thank You that You call me precious and that Christ gave Himself for me. When I feel worthless, help me believe what You say instead of what I feel. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #3 · MY WORTH

“I am not lovable.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief often grows out of love that was missing, inconsistent, or conditional. A parent who was cold, absent, harsh, or only affectionate when we behaved well can leave the impression that we are hard to love. Rejection by a spouse, friends, or a church can deepen it. People who hold this belief often keep others at a distance or try very hard to earn affection, and both can make relationships feel even less safe.

What Scripture teaches

The Bible teaches that God’s love does not begin with our lovableness. He showed His love by sending His Son while we were still far from Him. Paul was convinced that nothing in all creation can separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus. Zephaniah pictures God rejoicing over His people with singing. God does not love you because you finally became lovable; His love is what makes you beloved. People may fail to love you well, but their failure does not define your lovability.

> *“For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord”* (Romans 8:38–39).

Also see

> “This is how God’s love was revealed among us: God sent His one and only Son into the world, so that we might live through Him. And love consists in this: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins” (1 John 4:9–10).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

> “So that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. Then you, being rooted and grounded in love, will have power, together with all the saints, to comprehend the length and width and height and depth of the love of Christ, and to know this love that surpasses knowledge, that you may be filled with all the fullness of God” (Ephesians 3:17–19).

> “Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me” (Psalm 27:10).

Common self-statements

- If people really knew me, they would not love me.
- I am too much, or not enough, to be loved.
- Love always runs out for me.
- I have to earn every bit of affection.
- People only put up with me.
- Even God must find me hard to love.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Deciding that because some people did not love me well, no one can.

- Personalization: Assuming others' failure to love me is proof that something in me is unlovable.
- Mind reading: Believing I know that people secretly dislike me.
- Discounting the positive: Brushing aside kindness as pity or politeness.

Challenging questions

- Whose love was missing or conditional when I was growing up?
- Does someone else's failure to love me prove I am unlovable?
- What evidence is there that people have cared about me?
- Did God wait for me to become lovable before He loved me?
- How might I be pushing love away to protect myself?
- What would it look like to receive love without earning it?

Truth summary

> Some people did not love me well, and that hurt. But their failure is not a verdict on me. God loved me before I did anything to deserve it, and nothing can separate me from His love in Christ. I am loved, and I can learn to receive love from God and from others.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, By God
- God, All Loving
- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Love Take Me Over — Steven Curtis Chapman
Receiving God's love can shape loving action instead of fear or performance.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am not lovable"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am not lovable." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where was love missing or conditional for me?
- ☐ Does someone's failure to love me prove I am unlovable?
- ☐ What evidence shows people have cared about me?
- ☐ Did God wait for me to be lovable?
- ☐ How might I push love away?
- ☐ What would receiving love look like?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Nothing can separate me from God's love.
- ☐ God loved me first.
- ☐ Others' failures to love me do not define me.
- ☐ I do not have to earn love.
- ☐ God rejoices over me.
- ☐ I can let safe people care about me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- ☐ **1 John 4:9–10**
  "This is how God's love was revealed among us: God sent His one and only Son into the world, so that we might live through Him. And love consists in this: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins."
- ☐ **Zephaniah 3:17**
  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Love I noticed today: Each evening, write one way God or another person showed care for you, even something small. Note how you responded.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:38–39 becomes: "Linda can write: "Nothing in all creation can separate me from God's love in Christ, not even my worst days.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Love, By God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Make a "loved by God" list. Write down every verse on this card that speaks of God's love. Read one aloud each morning.
- ☐ Receive one kindness. When someone is kind to you this week, do not deflect it. Thank them and let it land.
- ☐ Reach out once. Contact one safe person you have been keeping at a distance and suggest coffee, a call, or a walk.
- ☐ Notice the old voice. When you think "I'm unlovable," ask whose voice that sounds like, and answer it with Romans 8:38–39.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “I am not lovable”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A time I let myself be loved
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am not lovable.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have believed I am too broken or too much to be loved. Thank You that You loved me first and that nothing can separate me from Your love. Heal the places where love was missing, and help me receive Your love and the love of the people You place in my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #4 · MY WORTH

“I am a failure.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief often comes from high expectations, harsh criticism, or being compared with brothers, sisters, or classmates. It can take root after a major setback such as a divorce, a business loss, a lost job, or a broken promise to ourselves. Over time a person stops saying “I failed at that” and starts saying “I am a failure,” as though one chapter were the whole story.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is full of people who failed: Moses, David, Elijah, Peter, and many others. God did not discard them. He restored them and used them. The Bible says a righteous person may fall seven times and still get up. Paul learned that God’s power is made perfect in weakness. God’s mercies are new every morning. Failing at something is part of being human; it is not your identity. In Christ, failure becomes a place where grace can work.

> *“But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me”* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

Also see

> “For though a righteous man may fall seven times, he still gets up; but the wicked stumble in bad times” (Proverbs 24:16).

> “Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> “Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, I press on toward the goal to win the prize of God’s heavenly calling in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 3:13–14).

> “The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in his journey. Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand” (Psalm 37:23–24).

Common self-statements

- I never get anything right.
- Everyone else succeeds; I don’t.
- Why try? I will only fail again.
- I have wasted my life.
- I let everyone down.
- One mistake ruins everything.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Turning “I failed” into “I am a failure.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that anything less than complete success is total failure.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will fail before I even try.
- Mental filter: Remembering my failures and forgetting what I have done well.

Challenging questions

- What exactly did I fail at, and is that the same as being a failure?
- What have I done well, even in small ways?
- Who taught me that mistakes make me a failure?
- How did God treat Peter, David, or Moses after they failed?
- What did I learn from this failure?
- What is one small next step I can take?

Truth summary

> I have failed at some things, like every person who has ever lived. But a failure is something that happened, not who I am. God restores people who fall, and His grace is enough for me. I can get up, learn, and take the next step with His help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Grace
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Strength
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Grace Wins — Matthew West
Grace offers a new beginning rather than defining a person by failure.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am a failure"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am a failure." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I fail at, specifically?
- ☐ What have I done well?
- ☐ Who taught me mistakes make me a failure?
- ☐ How did God treat people in the Bible who failed?
- ☐ What did I learn?
- ☐ What small next step can I take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Failing is not the same as being a failure.
- ☐ God's grace is enough for me.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ The righteous fall and get up again.
- ☐ I can learn from mistakes.
- ☐ God is not finished with me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **2 Corinthians 12:9**
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ **Proverbs 24:16**
  "For though a righteous man may fall seven times, he still gets up; but the wicked stumble in bad times."
- ☐ **Lamentations 3:22–23**
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I tried and what I learned: Each day, write one thing you attempted, how it went, and one thing you learned, whether it succeeded or not.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "Mark can write: "God's grace is enough for me. My weakness is where His power can work.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Grace" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Change the label. Write "I am a failure." Then rewrite it as a specific event: "I failed at ___ on ___." Notice the difference.
- [ ] List what you have done well. Write ten things you have accomplished or done faithfully, large or small. Ask someone who knows you to add two.
- [ ] Try something small. Choose one small task you have been avoiding because you might fail. Do it this week and note what happened.
- [ ] Read a restoration story. Read John 21:15–19, where Jesus restores Peter. Write what it tells you about how God treats failure.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie “I am a failure”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something I tried
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

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THE LIE

~~I am a failure.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have failed many times, and I have let failure tell me who I am. Thank You that Your grace is enough and that Your power works in my weakness. Help me get up, learn, and keep walking with You. Amen.

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